The Alignment Clinic
ORTHOPEDIC SPINE SURGERY

The Alignment Clinic of Spine Surgery & Orthopedics
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Clinical Letter

Prepared from the clinical visit note for care coordination and records.

Patient: LetterSmoke Beta
Date of birth: 1975-08-22
Date of service: 2026-11-07
Physician: Elvis Francois, MD

REASON FOR EVALUATION

Neck pain with right-sided arm numbness

HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS

58-year-old patient reports neck pain with right-sided arm numbness consistent with a radicular distribution. No additional history provided regarding onset, duration, trauma, weakness, bowel/bladder changes, or prior treatments.

RELEVANT HISTORY

Neck pain with right arm numbness for six weeks.

DIAGNOSTIC STUDIES

Cervical spine MRI ordered to evaluate for nerve root compression, disc herniation, or other structural causes.

EXAMINATION

Spurling test positive on the right. No other objective findings documented.

ASSESSMENT

1. Cervical radiculopathy — right-sided based on history and positive right Spurling sign

DISCUSSION AND PLAN

Discussed the plan to obtain a cervical spine MRI to evaluate for compressive pathology. Recommended conservative management while awaiting imaging, including activity modification, short-term NSAIDs as tolerated, and referral to physical therapy for cervical stabilization and nerve gliding exercises unless contraindicated. Advised that if severe or progressive motor weakness develops, pain becomes refractory to conservative care, or MRI demonstrates actionable compressive pathology, a neurosurgical/spine referral may be considered. Patient instructed to follow up with imaging results and to seek earlier care for worsening symptoms, new weakness, changes in bowel/bladder function, or increasing pain.

Elvis Francois, MD
Orthopedic Spine Surgeon
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